Democrats Win Control of Congress

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Voters across the United States have given the Democratic Party control of Congress. In the **midterm elections** on Tuesday, Democrats won the **House of Representatives** and the Senate. Before this, President Donald Trump's Republican Party held both.

Midterm elections happen in the middle of a president's four-year term. Voters choose all House members and about one third of the Senate.

The **Associated Press** reported that many voters were worried about high prices, a war involving Iran, and problems with **corruption** in government. Democrats won races in many states, from Texas to Iowa to New Hampshire.

Democratic leaders said the results show that people want big changes. President Trump said he accepts the results, but he plans to block laws that Democrats pass if he disagrees with them.

Democratic leaders also say they will look closely at the president and his team. That means Trump's last two years in office will have much more debate, and Congress will watch him much more closely.

Word Treasure

midterm elections -- Elections in the middle of a president's four-year term, when voters choose members of Congress.

House of Representatives -- One of the two parts of Congress that make the country's laws.

corruption -- When people in power act dishonestly or illegally for their own gain.

Associated Press -- A large news organization that collects and shares news reports.

Background you need

Midterm elections happen in the middle of a president's four-year term.

Voters choose the people who make laws in Congress.

If Congress and the president disagree, Congress can watch the president's work much more closely.

Break it down

WHO: Voters in the United States and the Democratic Party
WHAT: Democrats won the House and the Senate and took control of Congress
WHERE: Across the United States, in states from Texas to New Hampshire
WHY: Many voters were worried about high prices, a war involving Iran and corruption in government

Why it matters

The people who win elections make rules about prices and schools, so election results can change everyday life for families like yours.

Test what you remember

1. What happened in the midterm elections?

- (A) Republicans won both houses again
- (B) Democrats won control of Congress
- (C) The president resigned
- (D) Nobody won anything

2. When do midterm elections happen?

- (A) When it snows
- (B) Only in Texas
- (C) Every month
- (D) In the middle of a president's four-year term

3. Which party held Congress before this election?

- (A) No party at all
- (B) A brand-new party
- (C) The Democratic Party
- (D) The Republican Party

4. What worried many voters?

- (A) High prices
- (B) Bad weather
- (C) Homework
- (D) Sports games

5. What does President Trump plan to do with laws he disagrees with?

- (A) Sign them all
- (B) Sell them
- (C) Ignore them
- (D) Block them

6. What will Congress do more in the next two years?

- (A) Watch the president's team closely
- (B) Take long holidays
- (C) Stop meeting
- (D) Move to Texas

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: D 4: A 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Democratic leaders: Said the results show that people want big changes.

2. President Trump: Said he accepts the results, but plans to block laws that Democrats pass if he disagrees with them.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):